

Dr. Colin Campbell Editor-in-Chief *Journal of Advertising Research*

Dear Dr. Campbell,

I am submitting “AI Availability as a Third Measurable Layer of Brand Availability: Five-Substrate Empirical Anchoring of the AIAS Presence Measurement Protocol” for consideration as a peer-reviewed research article in the *Journal of Advertising Research*.

Contribution. The paper introduces AI Availability — the probability that an AI intermediary retrieves or recommends a brand in a category-anchored decision context — as a third measurable layer of brand availability alongside Ehrenberg-Bass Mental Availability and Physical Availability. The AIAS Presence Measurement Protocol operationalizes this construct through a pre-registered measurement program anchored across five consumer-product substrate families (kitchenware, fragrance, headphones, skincare, cosmetics), a locked six-LLM reference panel, and a versioned methodology chain (v1.2 through v1.6). The paper reports three headline findings from the most recent phase (cosmetics, v0.21): Type 2 dissociation cleared the EMERGED threshold, the Identity-Load moderator reached its first CONFIRMED verdict, and Phantom Brand Persistence was operationalized and confirmed. AIAS 1.0 names the Presence component of the construct; the full six-component composite is a multi-year research roadmap, and construct validity is held explicitly as future work.

Scope fit to JAR. The paper bridges academic measurement discipline and practitioner applicability in the way JAR’s mission emphasizes. On the academic side, the program operates under pre-registration discipline with locked panels, locked hypothesis matrices, and public data deposits at the Open Science Framework — six measurement events across five substrate families, each replicable against its locked protocol version. On the practitioner side, the two-channel Recall decomposition (canonical authority vs. cultural footprint) gives brand managers an auditable channel-level view of AI Availability with structural geometry: a brand’s position on the two channels locates which intervention class applies, and the Identity-Load gradient predicts which channel dominates for a given substrate cell. The Management Slant section of the manuscript frames these practitioner implications directly.

Scope boundary. The paper claims measurability under a falsifiable protocol, not construct validity. Predictive validity against behavioral outcomes and discriminant validity against Mental and Physical Availability are Phase 3 future work, named explicitly in the manuscript. This bounded scope is deliberate — the measurement claim is established; the validation claim is not yet earned.

Preprint disclosure. An earlier version of this manuscript was deposited on SSRN (Abstract ID 6817841) in May 2026 as the Author’s Original Manuscript under the author’s standard pre-registration citation convention. Per Taylor & Francis preprint policy, preprint deposit on a non-commercial server does not constitute prior publication and does not preclude journal submission.

Originality and exclusivity. This manuscript has not been published previously, is not under consideration elsewhere, and reports original work of the listed author. As the sole author, I have approved this manuscript and agree to its submission to the *Journal of Advertising Research*.

Sincerely,

Pablo Ulpiano González Castro School of Visual Arts, MPS Branding Program, New York, NY (primary academic affiliation) Third System (research entity; data archive and methodology venue) pablou@pablou.com
ORCID: 0009-0003-8968-9990